

Austin M. Elliott

EXPERIENCE

BACKPACKING

12 STATES

Led and completed multi-day trips across 12 states. Comfortable operating far from trailheads, cell service, and reasonable excuses to turn back.

- Completed 60 miles of the Ozark Highlands Trail in 4 days - a trip that sounded manageable at the planning stage.
- Led backpacking trips across varied terrain including the Wind River Range (WY), Baxter State Park (ME), and the Grand Tetons (WY); participants returned safely in all documented cases.
- Experienced a grizzly bear charge in Grand Teton National Park; resolved without incident and with no lasting behavioral changes toward backcountry travel.

CAR CAMPING

27 STATES, 250+ NIGHTS

Extensive field experience across 27 states and more than 250 nights outdoors. Operational range spans established campgrounds, national forest land, and random pull-offs.

- Logged 250+ nights camping across 27 states, a figure that reflects either a deep appreciation for the outdoors or a complicated relationship with hotel pricing.
- Hosted uninvited elk and moose in camp on separate occasions; neither escalated.

FLY FISHING

17 STATES

Active fly angler across 17 states with a portfolio of waters ranging from the technically demanding to the genuinely remote.

- Fished the Florida Keys, alpine lakes in the Wind River Range, remote brook trout waters in Baxter State Park, and west coast steelhead rivers - each requiring a meaningfully different approach.
- Ties own flies; has accumulated more materials than any single fishing trip could justify.

FORAGING & FIELD SKILLS

VARIOUS

Working knowledge of edible species identification, field food production, and navigation.

- Identified and harvested over 20 species of wild berries, mushrooms, and other foragables; zero adverse outcomes.
- Harvested wild mussels on the coast of Maine.
- Operated a 40-tap maple syrup operation for 5+ consecutive seasons, processing hundreds of gallons of sap into finished syrup; operation currently on hiatus.
- Competed in an orienteering race; finished. Map and compass navigation available as a skill in situations where GPS is unavailable or embarrassing to admit using.

SKILLS & EQUIPMENT

Gear: *Backpacking, camping, and fly fishing equipment holdings exceed any reasonable threshold*

Field Skills: *Leave No Trace, camp cooking, wildlife awareness, species identification, navigation*

Fly Fishing: *Dry fly, wet fly, nymph, Euro nymph, streamer, saltwater, dry dropper, spey, skated dry, swung wet*

References available upon request. Also real resume and references upon request.